

VI, by default, opens in the command mode. There are a bunch of options to switch into the insert mode. One of them is by typing 'i'.

How to open a file in VI or Vim?

To open a file in VI or VI M: type `vi filename`. This opens the file if it exists and displays the first few lines of the file. If it doesn't exist, it creates a new file.

Commands:

- **vi -R filename:** Existing file is opened in read-only mode
- **view filename:** Existing file is opened in read-only mode

Note: File name, error messages, and other information is displayed in the status line present at the bottom.

A tilde (~) will be present on each of the lines, which denotes unused lines. Its absence at the beginning of any line denotes that there is a space or tab or any other invisible character present.

How to navigate around VI

You have to be in the command mode to navigate around in the file without affecting any text that you have entered.

These are a few basic cursor navigation commands:

- **K:** Cursor moves one line up
- **j:** Cursor moves one line down
- **h:** Cursor moves one character left
- **L:** Cursor moves one character right
- **W:** Cursor moves to the next word
- **B:** Cursor moves to the previous word

Some more cursor navigation commands are:

- **O or |:** Cursor reaches the start of the line
- **\$:** Cursor reaches the end of the line
- **(:** Cursor reaches the start of the current sentence
- **):** Cursor reaches the start of the next sentence
- **^:** Cursor reaches the start of the current line on which it is located
- **+:** Cursor reaches the start of the next line
- **-:** Cursor reaches the start of the previous line
- **H:** Cursor reaches the top of the screen